

The Noble Dhāraṇī of Vajrabhairava

Ārya-vajra-bhairava-dhāraṇī-nāma · Toh 605 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྡོ་རྗེ་འཇམ་གཏི་མཁུ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ

Toh 605 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-vajra-bhairava-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Pakpa Dorje Jikjé kyi Zung, meaning "The Noble Dhāraṇī of Vajrabhairava." It belongs to the genre of dhāraṇī literature, presenting a sequence of sacred syllables and mantra phrases associated with Vajrabhairava, a wrathful tantric deity whose name means "Vajra Terrifier" and who is regarded as a fierce manifestation of wisdom. The text opens with a hymnic homage to the buddhas and bodhisattvas before delivering the dhāraṇī itself, accompanied by teachings on the merits and protective benefits gained through its recitation. As a dhāraṇī sūtra connected to the tantric tradition, it is classified among the tantra-related works of the Kangyur.

In the language of India: Ārya-vajra-bhairava-dhāraṇī-nāma. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī of Vajrabhairava.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

To the Victor together with his sons — stainless, purifying stains, boundless, inexhaustible, bestower of the supreme — vast beyond measure: may you ever bestow upon me, in accordance with my needs, the limitless supreme excellence.

Now these are my vajra words:

Ara ra. Asama. Samatā. Ananta dharmatre. Khaṇā khaṇā. Mahāvire. Cale samama. Āsahā. Mahābale. Kaṇa kaṇa. Mahābala. Āgrihe. Ha ha vajrā. Vajra hāye. Dhara dhara. Hūṃ hūṃ maṇḍala. Sama para akravikrame. Kuru kuru. Turu turu. Sarvathā. Sarvahi. Jvala jvala. Ākriṇi phaṭ svāhā.

If this essence of all vidyā-mantras and secret mantras is recited one thousand times before the Tathāgata, it becomes equivalent to reciting all vidyā-mantras and secret mantras one hundred thousand times. It also renders all other actions fruitful and unobstructed. Among all vidyā-mantras, secret mantras, essences, and dhāraṇīs arising from the rite of the three samayas, this performs all actions.

Then there is the rite, terrible as a vajra thrust — indestructible even by the gods of the thirty-three together with the nāgas and

spirits;

when he is angered even Śakra (Indra), worshipped by the gods, will tremble.
Scorned by none among all the elemental beings,
this is the supreme protector.

Just as in the world together with its gods there is no teacher equal to a buddha,
by these words of truth may all beings be protected.

Tadyathā: om vajra-prākāra vajra-prākāra vajra-daṃṣṭrā bhayābhahā curu
curu paricuma-vike. Culu tele. Namo ratna-trayāya. Namo vajra-bhairavāya.
Mahāgaṇapatisya. Vajraśakti. Paraśu. Pāśa. Hastāya. Vajra-kaṅka.
Vajra-vaiḍūrya. Alaṃkṛta. Śarīrāya. Vajrapāṇir anupālāya. Tadyathā: bhuru
bhuru. Ānayā ānayā. Mahāgaṇapati laghu laghu. Ehi ehi. Ākrama ākrama.
Śarīraṃ. Gṛhītam. Gṛhītam. Daṃṣṭrāmā. Daṃṣṭrīmābā. Atra viśatu śarīraṃ
kiñcirāyasi. Vidhuna. Badhana. Paṭa paṭa. Kampa kampa. Raṃga raṃga. Moda
moda. Dhama dhama. Vijṛmbā vijṛmbā. Pūra pūra. Ghūrṇa ghūrṇa. Āviśa āviśa.
Śīghraṃ śīghraṃ. Mahāvajra-bhairave. Gaṇapatirājñāpayati svāhā.

For the rite of routing all enemies and cutting all sorcery and curses: draw a square maṇḍala in the earth, then with a wrathful mind recite the mantra seven times over a weapon and thrust it into the ground — all sorcery and curses will be instantly severed.

For one who wishes to turn back an enemy army: recite the mantra seven times over a staff and hurl it in that direction — all enemies will be struck with confusion.

For one who wishes to bring nāgas under control: recite the mantra seven times over a vajra with a wrathful mind and strike the ground — the nāgas will come under one's power.

For one who wishes to avert hail: rotate the vajra without too much force and recite the mantra in a voice that is neither too secret nor too loud — the nāgas will refrain from sending hail.

For one who wishes to protect beer or fermented drink: recite the mantra seven times in praise over white mustard seed applied to the vessel — this will succeed in preserving it.

For one who wishes to pacify illness: recite the mantra seven times over water combined with medicine appropriate to the illness, and have it drunk or applied — the person will be freed from the illness.

For any and every activity one undertakes: recite the mantra seven times and whatever is intended will be accomplished.

The Noble Dhāraṇī of Vajrabhairava, called the Repelling of the Inauspicious, is complete.

Though the dhāraṇīs proclaimed by the noble ones are many in kind —

this supreme dhāraṇī spoken from the mouth of Vajrabhairava, possessed of the seven protective activities — the dhāraṇī of the holy yogin, not common to all —

was translated from the presence of Amoghavajra, the great lord of yogins, and the Tibetan monk

Translator's Notes

- The verse section beginning "Then there is the rite, terrible as a vajra thrust" is a compressed and somewhat elliptical passage in the Tibetan. The rendering follows the most natural doctrinal reading: the subject who is "angered" and before whom even Śakra trembles is understood to be Vajrabhairava himself, whose terrible power is being extolled. The final verse shifts register to a truth-statement invoking the Buddha's incomparable status as grounds for the dhāraṇī's protective efficacy.

The closing line "Though the dhāraṇīs proclaimed by the noble ones are many in kind —" is a colophon fragment that breaks off mid-sentence in the transmitted text; it appears to be the opening of a concluding verse whose remainder is not present in this passage.

The Sanskrit mantric syllables are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic rendering; they are not normalized to classical Sanskrit, as the original is clearly a liturgical phonetic transcription intended for recitation rather than grammatical Sanskrit.

- * The phrase "འོག་བླ་སངས་རྒྱལ་པོ་དུ་མིན་ཀྱི་ཡོད།" refers to Amoghavajra (Skt. Amoghavajra), the great Tang-dynasty master — literally "the great lord of yogins, Amogha-vajra." The text breaks off mid-sentence with "ཁོ་ཅག་གི་སྐུ་ཚངས་ཀྱི་ཕྲེང་ཆོས་ཀྱི་ཞུགས་པ་ཤིག་ཏུ་ཟེར་བ་ཡིན་པ་རེད།" meaning "the Tibetan monk [name]," indicating the colophon is incomplete in the passage provided.
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Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.